

TOUGH SURVIVORS

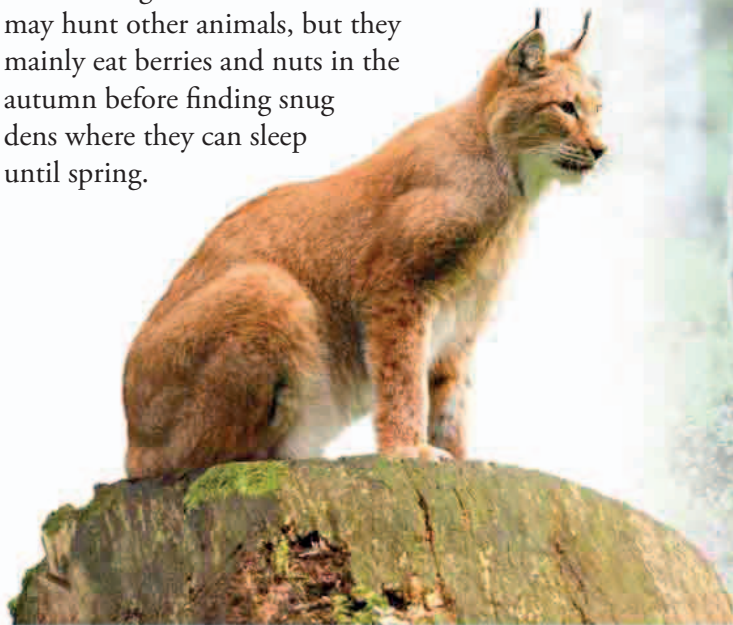
The animals that live all year round in the northern forests have to be tough to survive the cold. Only a few species are hardy enough. All the mammals have thick fur coats and spend the worst part of the winter asleep in their dens to conserve energy. Others stay active, including beavers, who dam streams to form pools around their homes. The pools freeze over, but the beavers gather food from beneath the ice.

FUR COAT ►

Thick fur helps this grizzly bear and her cubs keep warm, although they spend much of the winter asleep.

PROWLING PREDATORS

Hunters such as weasels, foxes, wolves, and this Eurasian lynx can usually find enough prey to see them through the cold winter. Bears too may hunt other animals, but they mainly eat berries and nuts in the autumn before finding snug dens where they can sleep until spring.



HARD TIMES

Around 300 bird species breed in the Eurasian taiga forest in summer, but only 30 of these stay for the winter. They include scavengers and hunters such as ravens, eagles, and this great gray owl. Seed-eaters such as grouse and crossbills may also stay. Most of the other birds fly south to spend the winter in warmer regions, returning to breed in the spring.